



VIBRANT LIFE

live life **connected**

FAMILY **PLAYBOOK**



Learn to Learn
Learn to Do
Learn to Be



2026 - 2027

Our Mission

To inspire each person who enters our doors to **find a calling
and change the world.**

We empower families to grow – and grow together – and
prepare learners to hear a call to adventure and begin a Hero's
Journey.

Every child is born with a gift. This journey isn't just about
learning.

It's about becoming.

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Welcome

TO THE PLAYBOOK

This isn't a rulebook. It's a guide – a shared understanding of how we move through this journey together as families, learners, and guides. It will keep evolving as we grow.

These are the things we are committed to, and here is why. You do not have to adopt them. **You do have to know them**, so your choice is a real one. And we will keep thinking about them together, all year.

We made this to help you feel grounded, to build clarity and trust, and to honor the heart of what we're building, together.

Reflect with us: What do you appreciate about your own education? How does family culture help shape a child's beliefs about learning and growth?



Watch: Why Vibrant Life

Jenna's why, one real "becoming" moment, and the promise. (60-90s)

[WATCH ON YOUTUBE →](#)

The Playbook

WHAT WE STAND FOR

1. **Learners are whole people.** They arrive with creativity, emotions, curiosity, and voice. They are geniuses – we honor both heart and mind.
2. **Families are partners and the primary educators.** Parents hold the primary responsibility; we walk beside you and support it.
3. **The learning environment matters.** Inspiring spaces where learners feel safe, challenged, and have a voice.
4. **Purpose leads the way.** We help learners discover who they are and what they're called to bring to the world.

What we hold, and what's yours. Because families are the primary educators, we keep our focus on academics, character, emotional development, and community. We don't instruct on charged political topics, human sexuality, or gender identity – families guide those at home – and we respect each family's economic, political, and religious freedom.

How to use this book

Read it. Use it. Revisit it. If you ask a question we've answered here, we'll lovingly guide you back to it – that's the learner-led way.

Philosophy & program

We help young people learn **how** to think, not **what** to think. We're an accredited **Acton Academy**, part-time with a wellness niche – your membership includes the curriculum and materials, no buying extra or teaching at home.

Learn

processes & habits of critical thinking

Do

skills, academics & real-world action

Be

character & matters of the heart

"We delight in the beauty of the butterfly but rarely admit the changes it has gone through to achieve that beauty." – Maya Angelou

Reflect with us: What family habits have etched positive character into your life? What energy-draining habits do you want to transform?

The Rules

WE PLAY AS A TEAM

The learner-led way is best thought of as a **game**. Imagine you're playing soccer and someone starts using their hands – are you still playing soccer? Vibrant Life is **different by design**. Clear agreements let us serve your family well. Guides and Jenna hold three **guardrails**:

Hold Studio Sacred

Be Kind & Respectful

Minimize Distraction

Each learner also agrees to studio commitments – integrity, respect & communication, excellence, inner work, community, and responsibility – until the tribe writes its own Session-1 contract.

What a Guide promises you

"If you change the way you look at things, the things you look at change." – Wayne Dyer

- To see your child as a genius with a gift to offer the world.
- To turn responsibility over to the learners as fast as they're ready.
- To hold the guardrails that keep everyone safe.
- To answer with Socratic questions, not answers – so the accomplishment stays the learner's.
- To stay on their own Hero's Journey, right alongside your child.

Fields of Play

OUR STUDIOS

Mixed-age studios with a shared vision. Learners are grouped by readiness, not strictly by age – increasingly learner-led from Tots up.

Tots Tribe

3-4

Play and experience are the child's important work. Welcome circle, movement, nature, story – plus a four-part parent recognition arc (Safe Base, Steady Hand, Witness, Held-Then-Let-Go).

Spark

5-7

Curiosity and purposeful play growing into self-directed work: early reading & writing, Montessori math, nature and science, low-tech Quests. Grows kindness, courage, and the first tools for big feelings.

Discovery

8-10

Quests blending science, art, math, and writing into a public exhibition; a writing workshop; deep reading; Socratic history. Grows goal-setting and owning results.

Adventure

11-14

Longer Quests in STEM, arts, and entrepreneurship; primary-source history; science labs; apprenticeships; badges. Grows servant-leadership, feedback, and grit.

Launch Pad

15-18 • soon

Know who you are, trust your capability, design your next great adventure: mastery through real audiences, mentors and internships, graduating with a portfolio and a public Launch Plan.



Watch: Studio Shorts

A guide's face and one real moment from each studio. (30-45s each)

[WATCH ON YOUTUBE →](#)

Daily Life

A DAY AT ACTON

Mon-Thurs (Tots Tribe Mon/Wed 9-11:30). 14031 Silver Ridge Road, Caldwell ID. Non-urgent: BAND; urgent: call/text Jenna 208-204-8819.

- **8:30-8:45** Outdoor play & drop-off (all weather)
- **8:45-9:00** Brain Gym at the grassy field, announcements, a wellness exercise
- **9:00 Game Begins** Work Block - morning circle, music, town hall, goals; reading, math works, writing workshop, Socratic Launch, Quests, closing circle & reflection
- **Midday-2:00** Lunch & outdoor play, eaten outside (work block ends ~11:30 Tots / 12:30 Spark & Discovery / 1:15 Adventure)
- **by 2:00** Pick-up at the roundabout (starts 1:50)

Calendar at a glance: Orientation Aug 4-7 • First Day Aug 17 • Last Day May 27. Seven sessions with a break between each; full month-by-month calendar shared separately.



Watch: A Day at Vibrant Life

The rhythm in motion, and a real exhibition - how growth works without grades. (60-90s)

[WATCH ON YOUTUBE →](#)

The Everyday

FOOD, PLAY, TECH & THE WORDS WE USE

Food & play. Nourishing food and a labeled water bottle daily; lighter on sugar (not "never"). Outside play is central, with managed risk – climbing, bare feet, muddy boots. **Exhibitions of Learning** are living report cards: learners show their work, and guides don't step in, because the exhibition is the learning.

Technology & health. A tool, not a toy – social-media- and game-free in studio. Tots screen-free; Spark guide-led; Discovery & Adventure sign a tech agreement and use a labeled Chromebook. Keep your child home for the symptoms in the onboarding guide; we trust each family's judgment.

The words we use

Student / Teacher	Learner (Hero) / Guide
Classroom / Classmates	Studio / Tribe mates
Grades / Report cards	Showing Mastery, Badges & Exhibitions
Worksheets / Textbooks	Quests, mentors & real-life experiences

Head in the Game

GROWTH MINDSET & KEEPING SCORE

This year our community reads *The Power of TED* (David Emerald) together: "victim" is not who we are – it's a stance we can step out of. **Victim** → **Creator** (the hero mindset), Persecutor → Challenger, Rescuer → Coach.

Hero mindset (Creator)

Welcome challenges, embrace responsibility, celebrate excellence, practice kindness, hold firm boundaries. *Partner, don't rescue – "What did you try? What's your next step?" Your calm is contagious.*

Victim mindset (a stance we shift out of) – avoid hard work, look for the easy way out, blame or make excuses. A pattern we can change, not who we are.

Keeping score: real growth, not just grades

We don't "keep score" like other schools. **Learners advance by readiness, not by birthdays.** Instead of grades, learners earn badges in the Journey Tracker – self-paced, and **the only comparison is you, yesterday.**

Reflect with us: When has a failure led to a greater lesson for you? Share it with your child. And – what makes a hero a hero?

Forming a Team

WHAT WE ASK OF YOU

We want VL to be a connecting place for the whole family. Choosing Vibrant Life is a family commitment, not a drop-off.

- ★ **Be reachable** during the day for a bathroom need or a moment of extra support.
- ★ **Join the community** – a volunteer team and the Skills directory.
- ★ **Come to parent meetings & Journey Meetings** – quarterly meetings, and your learner's goal-setting conference twice a year (around Sessions 2 & 5).
- ★ **Partner, don't rescue;** let your learner fail early, cheaply, and often.
- ★ **Bring an all-weather mindset;** use BAND and nonviolent communication.
- ★ **Provide gear & a device** – outdoor layers, plus a Chromebook for older studios.

If it's ever not the right fit: we talk it through first – two meetings with the guide and two with Jenna – and part ways, if we must, with grace. Current-month tuition is prorated and refunded.



Watch: Partner, Don't Rescue

A modeled before/after – the one commitment that changes the most at home. (60s)

[WATCH ON YOUTUBE →](#)

We're here to raise self-governed humans – young people who know their purpose, work for themselves, and choose courage and integrity when it's hard. The "win" isn't a GPA or a badge; it's a learner who can own their choices, repair quickly, think creatively, serve others, and keep going – because character has been practiced, not preached, in a real community.

Find a calling, change the world.

The Index

FOR YOUR REFERENCE

The front of this book is the welcome. This is the reference shelf – dates, contacts, this year's quests, the tools we use, the words we love, and every video in one place. Flip here when you need to look something up.

★ **The Calendar** – the full 2026–2027 academic year

★ **Details & Staff** – contacts, schedule, and your guides

★ **This Year & The Tools** – each studio's quests and the whole-child practices

★ **Words We Love** – the quotes and a reading corner

★ **Watch** – all four videos, one place

The Calendar

2026-2027 ACADEMIC YEAR

Vibrant Life | 2026-27 Academic Calendar



Dates worth circling: Guide training Aug 2-4 • Orientation Aug 4-7 • Opening Ceremony & Potluck Aug 14 (5-7pm) • First Day Aug 17 • Closing Ceremony & Potluck May 21 (5-7pm) • Last Day May 27. Seven sessions, each with a break between. Family activities, field trips, and exhibition times are shared separately as they firm up.

Details & Staff

CONTACTS, SCHEDULE, YOUR GUIDES

Phone Message on BAND for non-urgent. Urgent: call or text Jenna, **208-204-8819** (please add to your contacts – your child may call from this number or a guide's).

Address 14031 Silver Ridge Road, Caldwell ID

Daily schedule Mon-Thurs: 8:30 drop-off • 8:45 morning exercises • 9:00-12:30 work block (Adventure ends 1:15) • all-weather outside play until 2:00. Parents & Tots: Mon/Wed 9-11:30am.

Quick links vibrantlife208.org • BAND app (private group – contact Jenna for access) • Facebook & Instagram @vibrantlife208

Emails Jenna: vibrantlife208@gmail.com • Guides: vibrantlife208guides@gmail.com

Your team

Founder Jenna Jones (Ms. Jenna)

Co-owner Wes Jones (Wes) – financials

Parent & Tots Erin Stanley (Ms. Erin / Auntie Erin)

Spark Megan Bounds (Ms. Megan)

Discovery Rose Lerma (Ms. Rose)

Adventure Ben L (Mr. Ben)

Outside play Rotates

This Year & The Tools

QUESTS + WHOLE-CHILD PRACTICES

Every studio walks the same Hero's Journey at the scale that fits the learner. Here's the shape of this year.

Tots Tribe

A threshold walked with a parent, in two cycles: the parent recognition arc (Safe Base, Steady Hand, Witness, Held-Then-Let-Go), then the learner's Threshold Badges, leading to each tot's Pitch into Sparks.

Spark – following the seasons

1 Build the Tribe • 2 (Fall) Geography & Our Community • 3 (Cozy) The Body • 4 (Winter) Music & Art • 5 Debate • 6 (Spring) Farm to Table • 7 (Summer) Under the Sea.

Discovery – Quests + Story of the World

1 Build the Tribe (Lip Dub) • 2 E-Ship • 3 Colonial Acton • 4 Game Design • 5 Marine Science • 6 The Story of Energy • 7 Growing Curiosity. *Reading spine: Story of the World, Vol. 3 – Early Modern Times.*

Adventure – Quests + Civilization

1 Friendship & Strategies for Life • 2 Plan a Trip & Historical Speech • 3 Trial of Socrates & Greek Myth • 4 Apprenticeship • 5 Biology I • 6 Biology II • 7 Art & Creativity. *Civilization spine: Big Bang through the Modern World.*

The tools we use daily

Brain Gym • Heart Coherence breathing • the Wheel of Awareness • the 4-7-8 breath • EFT (tapping) • aromatherapy • and a Living Library of "living books." When learners can influence their own nervous system, life becomes a series of choices, not reactions.

Words We Love

QUOTES & A READING CORNER

"We delight in the beauty of the butterfly but rarely admit the changes it has gone through to achieve that beauty."

- Maya Angelou

"Encourage your child to have muddy, grassy, or sandy feet by the end of each day - that's the childhood they deserve."

- Penny Whitehouse

"I took a walk in the woods and came out taller than the trees."

- Henry David Thoreau

"We become just by doing just acts, temperate by doing temperate acts, brave by doing brave acts."

- Aristotle

"If you change the way you look at things, the things you look at change."

- Wayne Dyer

A reading corner. *Courage to Grow* - our onboarding read, the story of the Acton model. • *The Power of TED* (David Emerald) - this year's community read on the Creator mindset.

Watch

ALL FOUR VIDEOS, ONE PLACE

Short and warm – meant to add to the page, never repeat it. Each links out; swap in the real YouTube links before publishing.



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Jenna's why, and a real "becoming" moment. (60-90s)

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